

Caiyi Shen

M.S. Student in Game Science and Design
Northeastern University

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Education

Northeastern University

M.S. in Game Science and Design

09/2025 – 06/2027

Boston, MA, United States

University of Wisconsin-Madison

B.A. in Psychology; Certificate in Game Design

09/2021 – 08/2024

Madison, WI, United States

Research and Clinical Experience

UW Child Development Lab | Field Observer

University of Wisconsin-Madison

09/2023 – 02/2024

Madison, WI, United States

- Completed structured observations of preschool-aged children in a university child development laboratory setting.
- Observed peer interaction and social communication behaviors, including verbal initiation, turn-taking, joint attention, toy sharing, cooperative play, and responses to peers' social bids.
- Produced an analytical research essay synthesizing field observations with developmental psychology theories of preschool peer interaction, play-based learning, and early friendship formation.

Psychology Clinic | Clinical Assistant

Peking University Sixth Hospital

06/2023 – 08/2023

Beijing, China

- Learned and supported the supervised administration of transcranial magnetic stimulation (TMS), repetitive TMS (rTMS), theta-burst stimulation, and transcranial direct-current stimulation (tDCS).
- Assisted with electroencephalogram (EEG)-based visual-stimulus experiments to exam phobic response.
- Studied clinical ethics and professional conduct in psychiatric care, including informed consent, confidentiality, patient privacy, professional boundaries, and patient-safety protocols.
- Gained exposure to gender-related mental health services, including culturally sensitive communication with transgender women seeking clinical documentation for gender-affirming hormone therapy.

Learning, Representations, & Technology Lab | Research Assistant

University of Wisconsin-Madison

07/2022 – 09/2022

Madison, WI, United States

- Assisted with research on game-based STEM learning and representational competencies in a 3D astronomy education game.
- Observed playtesting sessions and documented learners' navigation patterns, verbal reasoning, confusion points, and interactions with astronomy-related visual representations.
- Organized participant feedback from playtesting to support qualitative review of learners' sense-making processes.
- Synthesized observation notes and transcripts into playtest summaries, helping identify usability barriers, conceptual misunderstandings, and instructional design improvements.

Project

AXIS AI | Project Lead & 3D Artist

Northeastern University

03/2026 – Present

Boston, MA, United States

- Collaborating with a faculty advisor [Prof. Ann Cai](#) to develop [AXIS AI](#), a cross-disciplinary AI platform that converts multilevel course materials into interactive 3D game-based learning experiences.
- Building, uploading, and testing psychology-, education-, and game design-related modules with pre- and post-learning assessments, AI-generated summaries, interactive activities, and backend analytics tracking user progress and engagement patterns.
- Creating 3D environments, visual assets, and tutorial videos.
- Helped secure Northeastern University's PEAK Fellowship, supported an ongoing NEA Grants for Arts Projects application.

Working Experience

Montessori Schooling | Teacher

08/2024 – 08/2025

If Montessori School

Houston, TX, United States

- Worked with preschool-aged children in a Montessori classroom, observing attention, learning engagement, social interaction, and responses to hands-on learning materials.
- Used developmentally appropriate and Montessori-informed strategies to support children's autonomy, language development, self-directed exploration, and classroom participation.
- Developed a play-based Chinese character learning activity based on observed patterns in children's visual attention, symbolic association, and interaction with learning materials.

Digital Media Content Creator

01/2024 – Present

NetEase Blizzard China Creator Partnership

Online

- Produce gaming, cosplay, and livestream for online audiences, growing a Douyin account to 20,000+ followers.
- Create Hearthstone-related videos through a creator partnership with NetEase Blizzard China, with one video reaching 1,000,000 views.
- Translate, adapt, and publish game design talks on Bilibili to make developer perspectives and interactive media concepts accessible to Chinese-speaking audiences.

Free Online Education Platform | Co-founder & Creative Director

08/2022 – Present

Schoolive Interactive

Online

- Co-founded a **Moodle-based educational platform** providing psychology, game design, and interactive media learning resources for Chinese-speaking students.
- Developed and organized course content with attention to instructional sequencing, learner accessibility, and clarity of psychological and design-related concepts.
- Directed development of an educational game project, integrating character design, narrative design, and gameplay mechanics to support learner engagement and interactive knowledge acquisition.

Awards & Scholarships

PEAK Fellowship: The Summit, \$3000

2026

Northeastern University

CAMD Graduate Scholarship, \$15000/year

2025

Northeastern University

Relevant Coursework

PSYCH 225 Research Methods

PSYCH 405 Abnormal Psychology

PSYCH 456 Social Psychology

PSYCH 464 Adult Development and Aging

PSYCH 501 Depth Topic in Social Science: Gender and Women's Studies

PSYCH 508 Human Emotions: Biology-Culture

PSYCH 526 The Criminal Mind: Forensic and Psychobiological Perspectives

PSYCH 532 Psychological Effects of the Internet

PSYCH 601 Current Topics in Psychology

Skills

Programming: R, R Studio, MATLAB, Python, GitHub, HTML/CSS, Twine, Oxygen XML Editor

Game Development : Unity, Unreal Engine, Autodesk Maya, Blender, ZBrush, Substance Painter, QuadSpinner Gaea

Design & Media Tools: Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Premiere Pro

Research & Clinical Skills: Behavioral observation, qualitative coding, playtesting documentation, participant feedback synthesis, EEG experiment support, TMS/rTMS/tDCS procedure observation

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (advanced), Japanese (advanced)